

Samsung Note PC Q30

Samsung's Q30 is a sleek form factor notebook that weighs just 1.1 kg. This Centrino notebook has an Intel Pentium M-A 1200 GHz processor, 512 MB RAM and a 40 GB hard drive. It bundles an external FireWire DVD-RAM ReWriter.

The 12.1-inch wide colour TFT screen supports 1280 x 768 pixels resolution. The connectivity options are Wi-Fi 802.11 B/G, 10/100 Mbps LAN as well as a 56 Kbps modem. It also features a card reader and has 2 USB 2.0 ports and a FireWire port.

It was below average in the Business WinStone 2004, scoring just 14.3. The battery lasted for a good 3 hours and 57 minutes.

It comes with Windows XP Professional and recovery CDs. The price of Rs 1,40,000 is too high.

Company **Samsung India Electronics India Ltd.**

Price **Rs 1,39,990**

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Rating



Logitech Mobile Freedom Headset

The Incredible Bulk

This Mobile Freedom Headset from Logitech is compliant with Bluetooth v1.2. The headset works with compatible mobile phones and PCs.

Weighing less than 30 gm, the headset is bulky. It has a range of 10 meters and is powered by a 140mAh rechargeable Lithium-ion battery.

The controls on the headset include a 'call answer button and a volume up/down button. The call answer button works as the power-up key as well and enables pairing up with other devices.

The rotating over-ear clip is not very comfortable to wear. Call clarity is exceptional, with a decent range.



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Rating



New & Notable

Bose TriPort Music System

Head For The Phones

The Bose Triport Music System consists of a CD/MP3 disc player and a Triport headphone. The player looks like any other Discman, but appearances can be deceptive!

Since it plays MP3 discs, a folder browser button lets you browse through folders. Another button is 'Browse' that lets you check the other tracks on the disc while you are listening to one.

The volume controls are placed on the top. Other buttons include the regular Play/Pause, Previous and Forward and Stop buttons. A unique MyMix button lets you create custom playlists from any MP3 disc that you are currently listening to, but once you switch off the player, the list is lost.

The headphone weighs only 5 ounces and looks flimsy, but it is just the lull before the storm. Once you wrap it around your ears, you will be surprised by the amount of reduction in the ambient noise. Remember, these are not noise-canceling headphones, but they perform a near-similar job. Nevertheless, the real pleasure starts when you hit play! The headphone can be summed up in one word—fantastic!

Some of the artists whose music we played on it were Nirvana, Pink Floyd, Madonna, Pearl Jam, Metallica, Alannah Myles, Chicane, Bryan Adams, Aerosmith, Lata Mangeshkar, Kishore Kumar, Mohd. Rafi, Beethoven, Claude Debussy... not necessarily in that order. Everything sounded amazing! You could hear notes that you previously did not



know existed. The music is perfectly balanced with no extra stress on the instruments than on the vocals—everything is crystal-clear.

Nonetheless, there are some downsides: in some songs, we noticed that the treble went intermittently high. This can be attributed to the quality of the Audio CD, too, but the sound jars at high treble and volume settings. Another factor is that each note is faithfully reproduced,

so for people who listen to low bit rate MP3 files, they will notice a flanging effect that is not apparent on low-end stereo systems or headphones.

So, is this combination the best that we have seen? In a manner of speaking, it is. It is the headphone more than the player that steals the show. However, there are much cheaper brands available today which do the job just as well.

The Anti-Skip function is one of the best we have seen. Finally, everything boils down to one all-pervading truth: this is a Bose. So, if you like to flaunt it, you have to get it!

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Rating

